

Nastrodavirus' Do's and Don'ts for Doctoral & Dissertation Writing

When writing, please avoid the following:

1. Do not use the word "that." Please review the writing assignments and remove the word.
2. Do not use the word "this."
3. Do not use "utilize" – use employ or use
4. Do not use "would, could or should"
5. Words like "all & both" are understood and unnecessary.
6. Do not use "many & few"
7. Do not use "can or may"
8. OFTEN
9. Potentially
10. All
11. Both
12. Overall
13. Almost
14. Still
15. All paragraphs are three sentences or more.
16. Do not use quotes. Write the material in your words and then provide the proper citation.
17. Each paragraph should have one or more citations.
18. Ensure you follow APA format and put the citations in the proper format.
19. Use New Times Roman font size 12.
20. Do not use automatic APA formatting tools for the references. Typically the APA formatting tools do not follow the APA 6th Edition guide.
21. Make sure you do not have any spelling, grammar, or punctuation issues in the writing assignments.
22. All tables and figures are black and white only. Ensure you follow APA format when using a table or figure; there should be two to three paragraphs written about why you have chosen the table or figure.
23. When writing utilize strong verbs and avoid the verb "to be."
24. Please check your work with online plagiarism checkers. It is important to check your written material early and often to ensure unique writing.
25. Correct tense – past tense in appropriate chapters.

